MODULE 9

Unexpected, Unexplained

"The true mystery of the world is the visible, not the invisible."

— OSCAR WILDE

ESSENTIAL QUESTION

What makes something mysterious, and what makes people want to solve mysteries?

MAIN SELECTIONS

1	**Mr. Linden's Library**	· Walter Dean Myers (illus. Ivan Kravetz)	MYSTERY
2	**The Loch Ness Monster**	· from National Geographic	VIDEO
3	**Finding Bigfoot**	· Martha Brockenbrough	INFORMATIONAL TEXT
4	**The Secret Keepers**	· Trenton Lee Stewart (illus. Chris King)	MYSTERY

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B · Reading Comprehension (32) ..... p. 6

C · IB Critical Thinking (5) ..... p. 10

D · MAP Practice (20) ..... p. 13

NAME _____ DATE _____

Worksheet A — Vocabulary

Module 9 · Unexpected, Unexplained · Grade 5 · 32 Items

CCSS L.5.4 · L.5.5 · L.5.6

NAME _____ DATE _____

Directions. Read each question carefully. Watch out for tricky choices. Fill in the circle next to the BEST answer.

BIG IDEA WORDS

Q1 L.5.6

falsify

To **falsify** something is to —

- ◯ **A.** read it out loud to a crowd.
- ◯ **B.** copy it word for word.
- ◯ **C.** change a statement or document to make it untrue.
- ◯ **D.** store it in a safe place.

Q2 L.5.6

effect

An **effect** in a piece of writing or art is —

- ◯ **A.** a deliberately created feeling or impression.
- ◯ **B.** the number of pages it has.
- ◯ **C.** the name of the artist.
- ◯ **D.** the price it sells for.

Q3 L.5.5 TRAP

suspense

Suspense is —

- ◯ **A.** a feeling of calm and boredom.
- ◯ **B.** a complete certainty about what will happen.
- ◯ **C.** a long and restful sleep.
- ◯ **D.** excitement or anxiety due to an uncertain situation.

Q4 L.5.6

factor

A **factor** is —

- **A.** a building where things are made.
- **B.** something that affects a situation.
- **C.** a number used only in math class.
- **D.** a person who tells a story.

CRITICAL VOCABULARY · MR. LINDEN'S LIBRARY

Q5 L.5.5 TRAP

formidable

Something that is **formidable** is —

- **A.** a bit frightening but also impressive.
- **B.** small, plain, and easy to ignore.
- **C.** soft, warm, and comforting.
- **D.** cheap and poorly made.

Q6 L.5.5 TRAP

relentlessly

If something happens **relentlessly**, it —

- **A.** stops after only a moment.
- **B.** happens once and never again.
- **C.** continues steadily and never stops.
- **D.** happens slowly and gently.

Q7 L.5.4

musings

A person's **musings** are his or her —

- **A.** shoes and clothing.
- **B.** thoughts.
- **C.** close relatives.
- **D.** favorite songs.

Q8 L.5.4

sentimental

Something that is **sentimental** —

- ◯ **A.** is made entirely of metal.
- ◯ **B.** can only be read at night.
- ◯ **C.** belongs to a library.
- ◯ **D.** has to do with feelings, often about the past.

Q9 L.5.4

prefer

If you **prefer** something, you —

- ◯ **A.** like it better than something else.
- ◯ **B.** give it away to a stranger.
- ◯ **C.** have never seen it before.
- ◯ **D.** are afraid of it.

CRITICAL VOCABULARY · MR. LINDEN'S LIBRARY (CONTINUED)

Q10 L.5.5 TRAP

engulfed

If one thing is **engulfed** by another, it is —

- ◯ **A.** left out in the open and uncovered.
- ◯ **B.** only lightly touched at one edge.
- ◯ **C.** surrounded or completely covered by it.
- ◯ **D.** kept far away from it.

Q11 L.5.4

audible

If a sound is **audible**, it is —

- ◯ **A.** written down on paper.
- ◯ **B.** colorful and bright.
- ◯ **C.** too high to reach.
- ◯ **D.** loud enough to hear.

Q12 L.5.4

will

In this story, a **will** is —

- **A.** a strong feeling of wanting something.
- **B.** a legal document that says what a person wants done with belongings after death.
- **C.** a kind of small sailboat.
- **D.** a promise made to a friend.

Q13 L.5.4

keepsake

A **keepsake** is —

- **A.** something you save to remember a person or an event.
- **B.** a list of chores to finish.
- **C.** a place where boats are kept.
- **D.** a kind of warm winter coat.

CRITICAL VOCABULARY · THE LOCH NESS MONSTER

Q14 L.5.5 TRAP

chastised

If you are **chastised**, you are —

- **A.** praised warmly for doing well.
- **B.** thanked politely by a friend.
- **C.** rewarded with a prize.
- **D.** scolded severely.

Q15 L.5.4

sightings

If there are **sightings** of something, people have —

- **A.** written stories about it long ago.
- **B.** seen it with their own eyes.
- **C.** built a model of it.
- **D.** argued about its name.

Q16 L.5.5 TRAP

earnest

If you say something in **earnest**, you are —

- **A.** only joking and being playful.
- **B.** bored and not paying attention.
- **C.** very serious and believe it to be true.
- **D.** unsure whether you mean it.

Q17 L.5.4

desperately

If you are trying **desperately**, you are —

- **A.** trying as hard as you can.
- **B.** barely trying at all.
- **C.** waiting for someone else to try.
- **D.** doing it slowly for fun.

Q18 L.5.4

convinced

If you are **convinced** of something, you are —

- **A.** confused about it.
- **B.** hoping someone will explain it.
- **C.** forgetting all about it.
- **D.** certain that it happened.

CRITICAL VOCABULARY · FINDING BIGFOOT

Q19 L.5.5 TRAP

misperception

A **misperception** is —

- **A.** a clear and correct understanding.
- **B.** a misunderstanding.
- **C.** a careful measurement.
- **D.** a proven fact.

Q20 L.5.4

hoaxes

Hoaxes are acts that involve —

- ◯ **A.** tricking and lying to people.
- ◯ **B.** teaching people new skills.
- ◯ **C.** helping people in need.
- ◯ **D.** exploring faraway places.

Q21 L.5.5 TRAP

elusive

Something that is **elusive** is —

- ◯ **A.** easy to find and simple to explain.
- ◯ **B.** bright and easy to see.
- ◯ **C.** common and seen every day.
- ◯ **D.** hard to find or understand.

CRITICAL VOCABULARY · FINDING BIGFOOT (CONTINUED)

Q22 L.5.4

theoretical

Something that is **theoretical** is based on —

- ◯ **A.** a photograph taken last year.
- ◯ **B.** a rule printed in a book.
- ◯ **C.** an educated guess rather than proof.
- ◯ **D.** something everyone has already seen.

Q23 L.5.4

encounters

Encounters are —

- ◯ **A.** long letters sent to a friend.
- ◯ **B.** meetings, especially those that are unplanned.
- ◯ **C.** careful plans made in advance.
- ◯ **D.** drawings of animals.

Q24 L.5.4

hastily

If something happens **hastily**, it happens —

- ◯ **A.** very quietly.
- ◯ **B.** long after it was planned.
- ◯ **C.** with great speed.
- ◯ **D.** in complete darkness.

Q25 L.5.4

muffled

A **muffled** sound is —

- ◯ **A.** quiet and hard to hear.
- ◯ **B.** loud and sharp.
- ◯ **C.** high and musical.
- ◯ **D.** bright and colorful.

Q26 L.5.4

gaping

If you are **gaping** at something, you are —

- ◯ **A.** hiding from it.
- ◯ **B.** pointing away from it.
- ◯ **C.** walking quickly past it.
- ◯ **D.** looking at it with your mouth open in surprise.

Q27 L.5.4

beckoned

If someone **beckoned** you, she —

- ◯ **A.** shouted angrily at you.
- ◯ **B.** made a gesture for you to come near or follow.
- ◯ **C.** turned and walked away from you.
- ◯ **D.** handed you a book.

Q28 L.5.5 TRAP

feeble

Something that is **feeble** is —

- ◯ **A.** strong and powerful.
- ◯ **B.** loud and forceful.
- ◯ **C.** weak.
- ◯ **D.** heavy and solid.

Q29 L.5.4

shudder

A **shudder** is —

- ◯ **A.** a shiver or trembling caused by fear.
- ◯ **B.** a wide, happy smile.
- ◯ **C.** a loud burst of laughter.
- ◯ **D.** a long, slow breath.

Q30 L.5.4

conviction

A **conviction** is —

- ◯ **A.** a small, careless mistake.
- ◯ **B.** a strong belief or certainty.
- ◯ **C.** a quiet whisper.
- ◯ **D.** a passing thought you forget.

Q31 L.5.4

faltering

Something that is **faltering** is —

- ◯ **A.** smooth and confident.
- ◯ **B.** fast and certain.
- ◯ **C.** loud and clear.
- ◯ **D.** hesitant and not confident.

Q32 L.5.5 TRAP

extinguished

When something has been **extinguished**, it has —

- **A.** started to burn brightly.
- **B.** grown larger and stronger.
- **C.** stopped shining or burning, or come to an end.
- **D.** begun to glow for the first time.

B Worksheet B — Reading Comprehension

Module 9 · Unexpected, Unexplained · Grade 5 · 32 Items

CCSS RL.5.1 · RL.5.2 · RL.5.3 · RL.5.5 · RL.5.6 · RI.5.1 · RI.5.2 · RI.5.3 · RI.5.5 · RI.5.6 · RI.5.8

NAME _____ DATE _____

Directions. Use what you remember from each selection to answer the questions. Fill in the circle next to the BEST answer.

Selection 1 · Mr. Linden's Library

MYSTERY · WALTER DEAN MYERS (ILLUS. IVAN KRAVETZ) · 8 QUESTIONS

Q1 RL.5.2

What is "Mr. Linden's Library" mostly about?

- ◯ **A.** A boy who finds a pocket watch with a secret.
- ◯ **B.** A documentary about a lake monster in Scotland.
- ◯ **C.** Carol, a curious girl who discovers that a book in Mr. Linden's library mysteriously changes.
- ◯ **D.** A scientist searching the woods for bigfoot.

Q2 RL.5.3

According to the text, how does Carol first come to borrow books from Mr. Linden?

- ◯ **A.** She asks Mr. Linden if she could borrow one of his books, surprising even herself, and he says yes.
- ◯ **B.** Mr. Linden mails the books to her house.
- ◯ **C.** A dealer from Westport gives her the books.
- ◯ **D.** She takes them from the Glace Bay Library.

Q3 RL.5.3

According to the text, what startling discovery does Carol make about Mr. Linden's book, *Tales From a Dark Sea*?

- ◯ **A.** The book is missing its cover.
- ◯ **B.** The book is written in another language.
- ◯ **C.** The book has Carol's name printed inside it.
- ◯ **D.** The story on page 201 keeps changing from day to day, even though the page number stays the same.

Q4 RL.5.1

According to the text, what warning does Mr. Linden give Carol about certain books?

- **A.** That she should read them only in the daytime.
- **B.** That a few books "capture more of the mind than one would want to surrender" and "are better off never read, never opened."
- **C.** That she must return them within one week.
- **D.** That the books are too expensive to keep.

Q5 RL.5.5

How does the author use the italicized story about Esteban and the dolphin within the main story?

- **A.** As a separate story-within-the-story, set off in italics, that changes each time Carol reads it and deepens the mystery.
- **B.** As a list of facts about dolphins.
- **C.** As the opening scene of the whole story.
- **D.** As a letter Carol writes to her mother.

Q6 RL.5.6

From what point of view is "Mr. Linden's Library" told, and how does it shape the story?

- **A.** First person, told by Mr. Linden himself.
- **B.** First person, told by the dolphin.
- **C.** Second person, speaking directly to the reader.
- **D.** Third person, from an outside observer who follows Carol's thoughts and keeps the book's secret mysterious.

Q7 RL.5.3

According to the text, what does Carol do after Mr. Linden dies?

- **A.** She returns all of her borrowed books to the library.
- **B.** She finds *Tales From a Dark Sea* under his pillow, takes it as a keepsake, and reads page 201 again at home.
- **C.** She decides never to read again.
- **D.** She gives the book to the dealer from Westport.

Q8 RL.5.2

Which sentence BEST states a theme of "Mr. Linden's Library"?

- **A.** A book is only worth keeping if it has pictures inside.
- **B.** A person who has traveled the world will always feel lonely at home.
- **C.** Curiosity draws people to mysteries, but some mysteries capture more of us than we expect.
- **D.** The safest way to enjoy a book is to read it only in the daytime.

Selection 2 · The Loch Ness Monster

VIDEO (DOCUMENTARY) · FROM NATIONAL GEOGRAPHIC · 8 QUESTIONS

Q9 RI.5.2

What is "The Loch Ness Monster" mostly about?

- **A.** A girl who borrows a mysterious book.
- **B.** How to bake a dessert from scratch.
- **C.** A boy who discovers a watch makes him invisible.
- **D.** How the legend of the Loch Ness Monster was created and how a famous photo was revealed to be a hoax.

Q10 RI.5.3

According to the video, what is the "surgeon's photo," and why was it important?

- **A.** A photo of a dolphin that proved a boy's story.
- **B.** A photo of the Loch Ness Monster that R. Kenneth Wilson claimed he took in 1934; it made "Nessie" seem real.
- **C.** A photo of bigfoot's footprints in the woods.
- **D.** A photo of an old library in Nova Scotia.

Q11 RI.5.1

According to the video, what "stunning revelation" did Christian Spurling later make?

- **A.** Sixty years later, he admitted the photo was a hoax and that his stepfather, Duke Wetherell, had falsified it.
- **B.** He admitted that the monster was real after all.
- **C.** He said he had never heard of Loch Ness.
- **D.** He claimed he took the photo himself.

Q12 RI.5.3

According to the video, how did Duke Wetherell create the famous photo?

- **A.** By drawing the monster on paper.
- **B.** By photographing a real animal in the lake.
- **C.** By making a head and neck for a monster and attaching them to a toy submarine, then taking a picture in Loch Ness.
- **D.** By hiring an actor to swim in a costume.

Q13 RI.5.8

According to the video, why did Duke Wetherell falsify the photo?

- **A.** Because he wanted to win a science prize.
- **B.** Because he wanted to get back at the *Daily Mail* for firing him.
- **C.** Because a scientist asked him to.
- **D.** Because he wanted to sell toy submarines.

Q14 RI.5.6

As a documentary, how does the video mainly present its information?

- **A.** As a made-up story with invented characters.
- **B.** As a single photograph with no words.
- **C.** As a list of recipes.
- **D.** As a narrator giving facts about real people and events to explain the topic.

Q15 RI.5.1

According to the video, why has the Loch Ness Monster held people's attention for so long?

- **A.** Because it is an unexplained mystery they want to solve, and there have been sightings of Nessie since the sixth century.
- **B.** Because Scotland has no other lakes.
- **C.** Because the monster has been captured and studied.
- **D.** Because no one has ever heard of it.

Q16 RI.5.2

Which sentence BEST states a central idea of "The Loch Ness Monster"?

- **A.** Once a photo is proven to be a hoax, people stop caring about the mystery.
- **B.** The surgeon's photo is the only reason anyone ever believed in Nessie.
- **C.** An unexplained mystery — and a famous hoax — can capture people's attention for generations.
- **D.** A single faked photograph can prove that a legendary creature is real.

Selection 3 · Finding Bigfoot: Everything You Need to Know

INFORMATIONAL TEXT · MARTHA BROCKENBROUGH · 8 QUESTIONS

Q17 RI.5.2

What is "Finding Bigfoot" mostly about?

- **A.** The arguments for and against the existence of bigfoot, and how to study the question like a scientist.
- **B.** A girl learning English in a new country.
- **C.** A boy and a dolphin swimming to an island.
- **D.** How a famous lake photo was faked.

Q18 RI.5.8

Why does the author begin by describing recently discovered creatures, such as a tiny frog and the lesula monkey?

- **A.** To prove that bigfoot has already been found.
- **B.** To explain how to take photographs.
- **C.** To show that interesting new animals are found all the time, supporting the idea that unknown creatures could exist.
- **D.** To list every animal in the world.

Q19 RI.5.3

According to the text, what is cryptozoology?

- **A.** The study of prehistoric life only.
- **B.** The study of "hidden" animals, from *crypto* ("hidden") and *zoology* ("the study of animals").
- **C.** The study of stars and black holes.
- **D.** The study of human movement.

Q20 RI.5.3

In the "Is Bigfoot Real?" section, how does the author compare believing in bigfoot to believing in black holes?

- **A.** She says both have been clearly seen by everyone.
- **B.** She says neither can ever be studied.
- **C.** She says black holes are easy to see but bigfoot is not.
- **D.** She explains that a black hole has never been seen, yet people believe it exists because there is enough evidence — and a theory about bigfoot could work the same way.

Q21 RI.5.5

How is the section "The Arguments for Bigfoot" organized?

- ◯ **A.** As a poem with rhyming lines.
- ◯ **B.** As a single long paragraph with no breaks.
- ◯ **C.** With a main heading and four subheadings that each give a category of evidence, such as eyewitness accounts and physical evidence.
- ◯ **D.** As a set of diary entries by date.

Q22 RI.5.6

What is the author's point of view about how people should investigate bigfoot?

- ◯ **A.** She believes a "healthy dose of skepticism" and an open mind, using the scientific method, are the right way to investigate.
- ◯ **B.** She believes no one should ever look for bigfoot.
- ◯ **C.** She believes only photographs can prove anything.
- ◯ **D.** She believes scientists should ignore all evidence.

Q23 RI.5.8

According to the text, what is the doubters' BEST argument against bigfoot?

- ◯ **A.** That bigfoot has been seen too many times.
- ◯ **B.** That the woods are too small to hide an animal.
- ◯ **C.** That eyewitnesses are never respected people.
- ◯ **D.** That people have been looking for a long time with technology like heat-detecting cameras and still have no body or proof.

Q24 RI.5.2

Which sentence BEST states a central idea of "Finding Bigfoot"?

- ◯ **A.** Bigfoot has definitely been proven to exist.
- ◯ **B.** Extraordinary claims like bigfoot deserve open-minded, evidence-based scientific investigation.
- ◯ **C.** Footprints are the only thing that matters in science.
- ◯ **D.** No new animals have ever been discovered.

Selection 4 · The Secret Keepers

MYSTERY · TRENTON LEE STEWART (ILLUS. CHRIS KING) · 8 QUESTIONS

Q25 RL.5.2

What is "The Secret Keepers" mostly about?

- **A.** A girl who keeps a diary in a new country.
- **B.** Reuben, a boy who experiments to uncover the secret of a mysterious pocket watch.
- **C.** A documentary about a lake monster.
- **D.** Scientists searching the forest for bigfoot.

Q26 RL.5.1

According to the text, what does Reuben already know about the watch that makes it unusual?

- **A.** That it is made of solid gold.
- **B.** That it once belonged to his grandmother.
- **C.** That it can tell the future.
- **D.** That a watch expert, Mrs. Genevieve, says it is "not an ordinary watch for telling time," and a figure called The Smoke has been searching for it for years.

Q27 RL.5.3

According to the text, what inspiration about how the watch might work does Reuben get from his old toys?

- **A.** The windup robot gives him the idea to throw the watch away.
- **B.** The action figures tell him to give up.
- **C.** The jack-in-the-box gives him the idea that the watch might open from the inside if it is set to a certain time and wound up.
- **D.** The toy camera tells him the watch is broken.

Q28 RL.5.3

According to the text, what happens after Reuben sets the watch to twelve o'clock and winds it?

- **A.** Everything goes black, and Reuben can see "nothing but darkness."
- **B.** The watch begins to play music.
- **C.** A tiny pouch of diamonds pops out.
- **D.** Nothing happens at all.

Q29 RL.5.3

According to the text, how does Reuben use the toy digital camera, and what does it prove?

- **A.** He uses it to call his mother for help.
- **B.** He uses it to read in the dark.
- **C.** He uses it to take a picture of The Smoke.
- **D.** He photographs himself while holding the watch; the photo shows his bed and closet but not Reuben, proving the watch makes him disappear.

Q30 RL.5.6

How might the story be different if it were told from Reuben's first-person point of view instead of third person?

- **A.** Readers would learn nothing about Reuben at all.
- **B.** Readers might feel more connected to Reuben because they would experience events through his eyes, but they would know less about other things.
- **C.** The story would become a poem.
- **D.** The story would have no mystery.

Q31 RL.5.5

How does the author build suspense as Reuben tests the watch again and again?

- **A.** By skipping ahead to the very end of the story right away.
- **B.** By listing facts about clocks.
- **C.** By telling events in chronological order and slowing the pacing during the tense waiting, so the reader feels the mounting tension too.
- **D.** By having another character explain the ending.

Q32 RL.5.2

Which sentence BEST states a theme of "The Secret Keepers"?

- **A.** Unlocking a secret can be exciting and terrifying at the same time, and patience and clever experimenting can solve a puzzle.
- **B.** Old toys should always be thrown away.
- **C.** Watches are the most valuable thing a person can own.
- **D.** It is best never to be curious about anything.

Worksheet C — IB Critical Thinking

Module 9 · Unexpected, Unexplained · Grade 5

IB PYP Key Concepts · DOK 2 – 4

NAME _____ DATE _____

Directions. Use what you learned from each selection to think more deeply about mysteries and why people want to solve them. Each question helps you grow as an IB learner.

Q1 Form DOK 3

In **"Mr. Linden's Library,"** the book *Tales From a Dark Sea* is mysterious. Show the CLUE Carol notices and how she TRIES to explain it, then explain what makes the book mysterious.

WHAT MAKES THE BOOK MYSTERIOUS

A CLUE CAROL NOTICES	HOW CAROL TRIES TO EXPLAIN IT

What makes the book mysterious? Use one detail from the text in your answer.

Q2 Causation DOK 3

In **"The Loch Ness Monster,"** a famous photo made people believe in Nessie. Show the CLAIM and the EVIDENCE that revealed the truth, then explain how the hoax was uncovered.

CLAIM AND EVIDENCE · THE SURGEON'S PHOTO

THE CLAIM (1934)

THE EVIDENCE THAT REVEALED THE TRUTH

How was the hoax finally uncovered? Use one detail from the video.

Q3 Perspective DOK 3

In **"Finding Bigfoot,"** the author weighs reasons FOR and AGAINST the existence of bigfoot. Show one reason for each side, then explain why "healthy skepticism" matters.

TWO SIDES OF THE BIGFOOT QUESTION

A REASON FOR	A REASON AGAINST	HOW TO DECIDE
what evidence supports bigfoot?	*what do the doubters say?*	*what does the author suggest?*

Why does the author say "healthy skepticism" and an open mind matter? Use one detail from the text.

Q4 Reflection DOK 3

In **"The Secret Keepers,"** Reuben does not give up on the watch's secret. Show the PROBLEM and how he SOLVES it, then explain what his actions reveal about him.

HOW REUBEN SOLVES THE MYSTERY

THE PROBLEM REUBEN FACES	HOW HE SOLVES IT

What do Reuben's actions reveal about him? Explain using one detail from the text.

Q5 Connection DOK 4

Essential Question: What makes something mysterious, and what makes people want to solve mysteries? Use ideas from TWO of the selections in this module to answer.

TWO-SELECTION SYNTHESIS

SELECTION 1 · TITLE

What made this mystery, and why did someone want to solve it?

SELECTION 2 · TITLE

What made this mystery, and why did someone want to solve it?

MY BIG IDEA

Worksheet D — MAP Practice

Module 9 · Unexpected, Unexplained · Grade 5

MAP RIT 205 → 225 · 4 Mini-Passages × 5 Questions

NAME _____ DATE _____

Directions. Read each short passage carefully. Then answer the 5 questions that follow. Each passage is NEW — not from the selections in this workbook.

Passage 1 · The Crow's Treasure

Maya noticed it the moment she stepped into the kitchen: her grandmother's ring was gone from the little dish by the window. The dish had held that ring for as long as Maya could remember. Now it was empty. Her grandmother looked worried, so Maya decided to act like a detective. First she asked questions. Had anyone opened the window? Yes, her brother had, to let in fresh air. Next she looked for clues. On the windowsill she found a few crumbs and a single gray feather. Then she made a guess, the way scientists do. Maybe a bird had flown in and carried the shiny ring away. It sounded wild, but it fit the clues. Maya climbed onto a chair and peered at the top of the tall cabinet. There, tucked into a messy nest of string and paper, the ring glinted in the light. A clever crow had been visiting the yard all week, and it loved shiny things. Maya laughed with relief as she returned the ring to its dish. The mystery had a simple answer after all — but only because she had stopped to gather clues, ask questions, and think it through like a real investigator.

199 WORDS · LEXILE 620–710L · RIT 205–211

Q1 RIT 205 Lexile 620L Key Detail

What does Maya notice at the start of the passage?

- ◯ **A.** The window is broken.
- ◯ **B.** Her brother is missing.
- ◯ **C.** Her grandmother's ring is gone from the dish by the window.
- ◯ **D.** The kitchen is full of birds.

Q2 RIT 207 Lexile 645L Key Detail

What clues does Maya find on the windowsill?

- ◯ **A.** A few crumbs and a single gray feather.
- ◯ **B.** A note written by her brother.
- ◯ **C.** A pile of string and paper.
- ◯ **D.** Muddy paw prints.

Q3 RIT 208 · Lexile 665L · Cause & Effect

What had really happened to the ring?

- ◯ **A.** Her brother had hidden it as a joke.
- ◯ **B.** It had fallen behind the dish.
- ◯ **C.** Her grandmother had moved it herself.
- ◯ **D.** A crow had carried it to a nest on top of the cabinet.

Q4 RIT 210 · Lexile 690L · Inference

Why does the author compare Maya to a detective and a scientist?

- ◯ **A.** Because she is afraid of birds.
- ◯ **B.** Because she asks questions, gathers clues, and tests a guess to solve the mystery.
- ◯ **C.** Because she wears a special uniform.
- ◯ **D.** Because she gives up quickly.

Q5 RIT 211 · Lexile 710L · Theme

What is the main message, or theme, of this passage?

- ◯ **A.** Crows make good pets.
- ◯ **B.** Windows should always be kept closed.
- ◯ **C.** Careful thinking and gathering clues can solve a puzzling mystery.
- ◯ **D.** Rings are the most valuable thing a family can own.

Passage 2 · Why People Love a Good Mystery

Why do so many people love a good mystery? Stories about puzzles, secrets, and strange events have entertained readers for hundreds of years, and experts have a few ideas about why. One reason is that a mystery offers a safe kind of excitement. A reader can feel the thrill of danger or surprise while sitting comfortably in a chair, knowing that no real harm can come. Another reason is the puzzle itself. Human beings naturally like to figure things out. When a story hides a secret, readers want to gather the clues and solve it before the ending is revealed. A mystery also makes people pay close attention. To find the answer, a reader must notice small details, compare them, and decide which ones matter. In this way, mysteries are a kind of mental exercise. Scientists enjoy mysteries for the same reasons. They study clues from the past and the natural world, then build careful explanations, almost like detectives. Whether the puzzle is in a book or in real life, the pleasure is much the same. People love mysteries because they are exciting, because they give us something to figure out, and because solving them makes us feel clever and curious about the world.

204 WORDS · LEXILE 760–860L · RIT 211–217

Q6 RIT 211 Lexile 760L Key Detail

According to the passage, what is one reason a mystery offers "a safe kind of excitement"?

- **A.** A reader can feel the thrill of danger while knowing no real harm can come.
- **B.** A reader must travel to faraway places.
- **C.** A reader always knows the ending first.
- **D.** A reader never has to think at all.

Q7 RIT 213 Lexile 790L Key Detail

According to the passage, why do people enjoy "the puzzle itself"?

- **A.** Because puzzles are always easy.
- **B.** Because they dislike paying attention.
- **C.** Because the answer is given at the start.
- **D.** Because human beings naturally like to figure things out and solve clues before the ending.

Q8 RIT 214 Lexile 810L Vocabulary

In the passage, the phrase **"a kind of mental exercise"** means that mysteries —

- **A.** are a form of physical sport.
- **B.** make the mind work and think hard.
- **C.** put readers to sleep.
- **D.** are only for scientists.

Q9 RIT 215 Lexile 830L Author's Purpose

Why does the author mention that scientists enjoy mysteries too?

- **A.** To prove that only scientists like mysteries.
- **B.** To explain how to write a book.
- **C.** To show that solving real-life puzzles, like a detective, brings the same pleasure as reading a mystery.
- **D.** To list the names of famous scientists.

Q10 RIT 217 Lexile 860L Main Idea

What is the main idea of "Why People Love a Good Mystery"?

- **A.** People love mysteries because they are exciting, give us something to figure out, and make us feel clever and curious.
- **B.** Mysteries are too scary for most readers.
- **C.** Only children enjoy mysteries.
- **D.** Mysteries have only been written recently.

Passage 3 · The Classroom Plant Mystery

For two weeks, the students in Room 12 arrived each morning to find their classroom plants drooping and dry, even though the teacher, Mr. Ortiz, watered them every afternoon before going home. It seemed impossible. Who, or what, was emptying the pots overnight? The class decided to solve the mystery together. They began by writing down everything they knew. The plants were fine in the afternoon and dry by morning, so something happened at night. Next they searched for clues. Near the window they spotted tiny muddy paw prints and a gap where the old frame did not quite close. Someone suggested a theory: maybe an animal was sneaking in to drink the water. To test the idea, the students borrowed a small camera and left it running overnight. The next day, they crowded around the screen. There, in the gray light before dawn, a curious raccoon squeezed through the gap, tipped each pot, and lapped up the water. The mystery was solved — not by luck, but by careful thinking. The class sealed the gap, and the plants recovered. Mr. Ortiz smiled and told them they had worked exactly like real scientists, asking questions, collecting evidence, and testing an idea until they found the truth.

204 WORDS · LEXILE 820–910L · RIT 217–222

Q11 RIT 217 | Lexile 820L | Key Detail

According to the passage, what mystery does Room 12 set out to solve?

- **A.** Why the classroom is always cold.
- **B.** Who broke the classroom window.
- **C.** Where Mr. Ortiz goes after school.
- **D.** Why the plants are dry each morning even though they are watered every afternoon.

Q12 RIT 218 | Lexile 845L | Key Detail

According to the passage, what clues do the students find near the window?

- **A.** A gray feather and some crumbs.
- **B.** Tiny muddy paw prints and a gap in the old frame.
- **C.** A note left by another class.
- **D.** A broken watering can.

Q13 RIT 219 | Lexile 870L | Sequence

What do the students do to TEST their theory?

- **A.** They borrow a small camera and leave it running overnight.
- **B.** They stop watering the plants completely.
- **C.** They move the plants to another room.
- **D.** They ask the principal to solve it.

Q14 RIT 220 · Lexile 890L · Cause & Effect

What was really causing the plants to go dry?

- ◯ **A.** The plants needed more sunlight.
- ◯ **B.** Mr. Ortiz forgot to water them.
- ◯ **C.** A raccoon squeezed in through the gap and drank the water at night.
- ◯ **D.** The pots had holes in the bottom.

Q15 RIT 222 · Lexile 910L · Theme

What is the main message, or theme, of this passage?

- ◯ **A.** Raccoons are dangerous animals.
- ◯ **B.** Asking questions, collecting evidence, and testing an idea can solve a mystery, just as scientists do.
- ◯ **C.** Classroom plants are too hard to care for.
- ◯ **D.** Old windows should never be used.

Passage 4 · Unsolved Mysteries of Nature

Even today, the natural world is full of unsolved mysteries, and scientists work patiently to explain them. For many years, people wondered how monarch butterflies, which weigh almost nothing, could travel thousands of miles each year to the very same forests. No one had followed them the whole way. Researchers attacked the puzzle the way detectives solve a case. They gathered evidence, tagging the wings of thousands of butterflies with tiny labels and asking people across the country to report where the tagged insects appeared. Slowly, a picture formed. The reports traced a long path south, and at last the hidden wintering forests were found. Other mysteries remain. Scientists still study how certain birds find their way home over the ocean, and how deep-sea creatures survive where sunlight never reaches. To investigate, researchers ask a clear question, collect careful observations, and form a theory that can be tested again and again. Sometimes the answer takes many years, and sometimes new tools are needed before a question can be answered at all. That is part of what makes science exciting. Each unsolved mystery is an invitation to look closer, to keep an open mind, and to follow the evidence wherever it leads — just as a good detective would.

206 WORDS · LEXILE 900–1000L · RIT 219–225

Q16 RIT 219 · Lexile 900L · Key Detail

According to the passage, what mystery did people wonder about for many years?

- ◯ **A.** Why butterflies have colorful wings.
- ◯ **B.** How birds build their nests.
- ◯ **C.** Why the ocean is salty.
- ◯ **D.** How monarch butterflies travel thousands of miles to the very same forests.

Q17 RIT 220 | Lexile 925L | Key Detail

According to the passage, how did researchers gather evidence about the butterflies?

- **A.** By tagging thousands of wings and asking people to report where the tagged insects appeared.
- **B.** By keeping all the butterflies in a single cage.
- **C.** By guessing without any observations.
- **D.** By studying only one butterfly.

Q18 RIT 221 | Lexile 950L | Cause & Effect

According to the passage, what happened as the reports came in?

- **A.** The butterflies disappeared for good.
- **B.** Scientists stopped studying them.
- **C.** The reports traced a long path south, and at last the hidden wintering forests were found.
- **D.** The labels fell off and the study failed.

Q19 RIT 223 | Lexile 975L | Author's Purpose

Why does the author describe the steps researchers use — asking a question, collecting observations, and forming a theory?

- **A.** To prove that mysteries can never be solved.
- **B.** To show that scientists investigate the unknown in a careful, step-by-step way, like detectives.
- **C.** To explain how to catch butterflies for fun.
- **D.** To list the names of deep-sea creatures.

Q20 RIT 225 | Lexile 1000L | Main Idea

What is the main idea of "Unsolved Mysteries of Nature"?

- **A.** Butterflies are the only mystery left in nature.
- **B.** Science is boring because answers take so long.
- **C.** Nature has no mysteries left to solve.
- **D.** Nature is full of unsolved mysteries, and scientists patiently follow the evidence to explain them.